

Unit 13

Field Work and Report Writing



Chapter Outline

13.1 Introduction

13.2 Need for field work

13.3 Field work process

13.4 Field Report

Learning Objectives:

- *Recognise the importance of field work in geography*
- *Acquire the skill of data collection.*
- *Enhance the ability for map reading and field sketching.*
- *Learn to work as a team.*
- *Develop the skill of report writing*

13.1 Introduction

The study area for geographers is so vast that for a student of geography, the knowledge of the earth is acquired through class room teaching, books, journals, maps, internet etc. Theoretical knowledge about the study area can be learned in the class room while the practical aspects could be acquired only in the field through surveys.

Field work can be defined as, "The process of observing and collecting data about the natural and manmade environment". Geography is divided into two main branches: physical and human or cultural geography. Field work helps in bringing about a better understanding of the subject for a student of geography. In the case of understanding physical geography, field work becomes inevitable.

13.2 Need for field work

There are many reasons why field work is very essential for the students of geography. They are:

1. Field work facilitates direct observation of the study area (local area) and to collect original information.
2. Field observation along with class room teaching helps the students to understand the geographical concepts better.
3. Repeated field observation of the same place at regular intervals help to understand the changing patterns or trends of a phenomena. Example 1. Quality and growth of vegetation during different seasons. 2. Changes

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